A2 PRE-INTERMEDIATE ENGLISH

This module helps learners develop A2-level English skills for everyday communication, including giving directions, making plans, and discussing past and future events.

Directions and Location Instructions

Use these prepositions, expressions, and patterns to describe locations, ask for directions, and explain how to get to places.

Prepositions of Place

Use these prepositions to describe where things are and how to find them.

- **in** – enclosed or larger spaces
- **on** – surface or device
- **at** – specific point or event
- **across from/opposite** – facing each other
- **among** – surrounded by many
- **beside/next to** – directly at the side of
- **by/near** – close to
- **behind** – at the back
- **in front of** – ahead
- **between** – middle
- **beyond** – further away

Examples:

- *in* the room/*in* the box
- *on* the table/*on* the wall
- *at* the bus stop/*at* school
- *across from* the library/ *opposite* the station
- *next to* the shop/*near* the school
- *behind* the house
- *in front of* the gate
- *between* the trees

Common Places in Town/City

Use these words when talking about the places you visit in town or a city.

Transport

- bus stop
- train station
- airport

Shopping and Food

- supermarket
- shopping mall
- bakery
- bookshop
- restaurant

Public Services

- post office
- bank
- hospital
- pharmacy
- police station
- fire station

Education

- school/university
- library

Leisure and Culture

- park
- cinema
- museum
- swimming pool
- stadium

Religious Places

- church
- mosque
- temple

Asking for Directions

Use these patterns when you want to ask how to reach a place.

Patterns

- How do I get to + (place)?
- How do I get to + (place) from (place)?
- Where is + (place)?
- Is there a + (place) near here?
- Can you tell me the way to + (place)?
- Which way is it to the (place)?

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Examples:

- How do I get to the **train station**?
- How do I get to the **museum** from **here**?
- Where is the **supermarket**?
- Is there a **pharmacy** near here?
- Can you tell me the way to the l**ibrary**?
- Which way is it to the **beach**?

Sample Conversation:

Megan: Hi! Could you tell me where the **shopping mall** is?

Clark: Sure! It's across the street, right next to the **post office**.

Megan: Thank you.

Sample Conversation:

Jackson: Excuse me, can you show me the way to the nearest **bank**?

Jacob: Of course! Walk past the **supermarket**, and you'll see it right beside the **library**.

Jackson: Great, thanks!

Giving Directions

Use these when giving simple instructions.

- Go straight.
- Turn left/right.
- Cross the street.
- It's on your left/on your right.
- It's next to/opposite/between.

Sample Conversation:

Stormi: Excuse me, where is **the library**?

Kylie: Go straight and turn right. The library will be on your left.

Stormi: Thank you!

Sample Conversation:

Ariana: Hi, how can I get to the cinema?

Selena: Go straight two blocks, then turn left. It's next to the park.

Ariana: Got it, thanks!

Expressing Time and Distance

Use these when talking about how far a place is and how long it takes to get there.

Time Expressions

- It takes (time) to get there.
- It is (time) on foot/by car/by bus.
- It's about (time) away.
- You can get there in (time).
- It only takes a few minutes.

Distance Expressions

- Is it far from here?
- It's very close.
- It's not far.
- It's near/close to ____.
- It's far from here.
- It's just around the corner.
- It's within walking distance.
- It's about (distance) from here.

Sample Conversation:

Taylor: Excuse me, is the bus stop far from here?

Travis: No, it's very close. It's just around the corner.

Taylor: Thanks a lot!

Sample Conversation:

Clark: How long does it take to get to the museum on foot?

Lois: It takes about ten minutes.

Clark: Thanks, that helps!

Making Appointments and Plans

Use these to ask, suggest, accept, decline, reschedule, and confirm appointments.

Asking and Suggesting

- When are you free?
- What day is good for you?
- What time is best for you?

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- Are you free this week?
- Let's meet soon.
- Maybe we can meet one day.
- How about tomorrow?
- We can do it in the morning/afternoon/evening.
- Does (time) work for you?

Accepting Invitations

- Yes, that's fine.
- I'm free then.
- Sure, no problem.
- I'd love to.
- Sounds great!
- That works for me.
- Perfect!
- Great idea!

Declining or Rescheduling

- Sorry, I can't.
- Sorry, I'm not free.
- I'm busy then.
- I'm afraid I can't make it.
- That doesn't work for me.
- I have another appointment then.
- Can we reschedule?
- How about another day/time?

Confirming Appointments

- Just to confirm, we're meeting on (day) at (time), right?
- See you on (day) at (time).
- Is (time) still good for you?
- Looking forward to seeing you.

Sample Conversation:

Homer: When are you free?

Marge: I'm free **this week**.

Homer: How about **Wednesday morning**?

Marge: I have another appointment then.

Homer: Okay. How about **Thursday afternoon**?

Marge: That works! Thanks.

Sample Conversation:

Bart: Let's meet next week.

Lisa: Sounds great! When are you free?

Bart: How about **Friday afternoon**?

Lisa: Perfect! I'm free then.

Sample Conversation:

Peter: Just to confirm, we're meeting on Thursday at 2 p.m., right?

Wendy: Yes, that's right.

Peter: Great, see you then!

Past Events and Future Plans

Use these to talk about things that have already happened, things you plan to do in the future, and experiences you've had.

Grammar Tip

- Adverbs of time usually go at the **end** of the sentence.
- They can also go at the **beginning** to emphasize when something happens.
- Use the **simple past** for events at a **specific time**.
- Use the **present perfect tense** (has/have + past participle) for experiences **without specifying when**.

Adverbs of Time for the Past

- yesterday
- last night/last week/last month/last year
- a few days ago/a few weeks ago/an hour ago
- a long time ago
- a while ago
- in + (year) → in 2010
- in + (month) → in May
- the other day

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Useful Expressions

- I've never … before.
- I've already…
- It was my first time…
- I went to…
- It was fun.

Sample Conversation:

Harry: What did you do **yesterday**?

Sally: I **watched** a movie.

Harry: That sounds fun! Did you go out **last night**?

Sally: No, I **stayed** at home.

Sample Conversation:

Fred: When did you start learning English?

Ginger: I started in **2015**.

Fred: Really? That's a long time!

Ginger: Yes, I began learning it **a long time ago**.

Talking About Future Plans

Use these to talk about things you plan to do or try in the future.

Grammar Tip

- Use **going to** or **will** to talk about plans or intentions.

Useful Expressions

- I've always wanted to…
- I'm going to…
- I want to try…
- I hope to…

Adverbs of Time for the Future

- tomorrow
- tomorrow morning/afternoon/evening
- next week/next month/next year
- soon/later/in the future/this weekend

Sample Conversation:

Tom: When are you free to meet?

Jerry: I'm free **tomorrow afternoon**.

Tom: Great! Let's meet then.

Jerry: Perfect! See you **tomorrow**.

Sample Conversation:

Tony: I want to try surfing this **summer**.

Maria: That sounds fun! Are you going to the **beach** soon?

Tony: Yes, I'm going to the beach **next week** to try it.

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References:

British Council. *A2 Pre-intermediate.*
https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/english-levels/understand-your-english-level/a2-pre-intermediate

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